

Learn with AI

Here’s the good news: when it comes to studying, AI might be the most powerful tool you’ll ever get your hands on. Used the right way, it doesn’t just help you finish the work, it makes you genuinely sharper at the subject.

It’s the most patient tutor you’ll ever meet. It’ll quiz you at 1am, never sigh when you ask again, and meet you exactly where you’re stuck.

The first move is choosing which kind of AI to aim at the job. There’s a simple question to guide your choice: do you want to learn from materials you already have, or learn something new?

Which study tool for the job?

 **NOTEBOOKLM**

Source-grounded Tutor

Learns from your materials.

It only knows what you give it, which makes it the ultimate exam-prep machine.

 **BEST USE**

You have the materials the test covers: class notes, screenshots, study guides, even a webpage or YouTube video.

 **THE CATCH**

It doesn't know what you didn't give it. If your notes are missing a key concept, it can't reliably fill the gap, because it only works from the materials you gave it.

 **CHATGPT · CLAUDE · GEMINI**

General Tutor

Makes things from scratch.

Trained on massive amounts of data, it can explain or quiz you on almost anything.

 **BEST USE**

You don't have the materials, or you want a concept explained a new way or extra practice your notes don't cover.

 **THE CATCH**

It can occasionally make things up, or explain a concept differently than how your teacher taught it and expects on the exam.

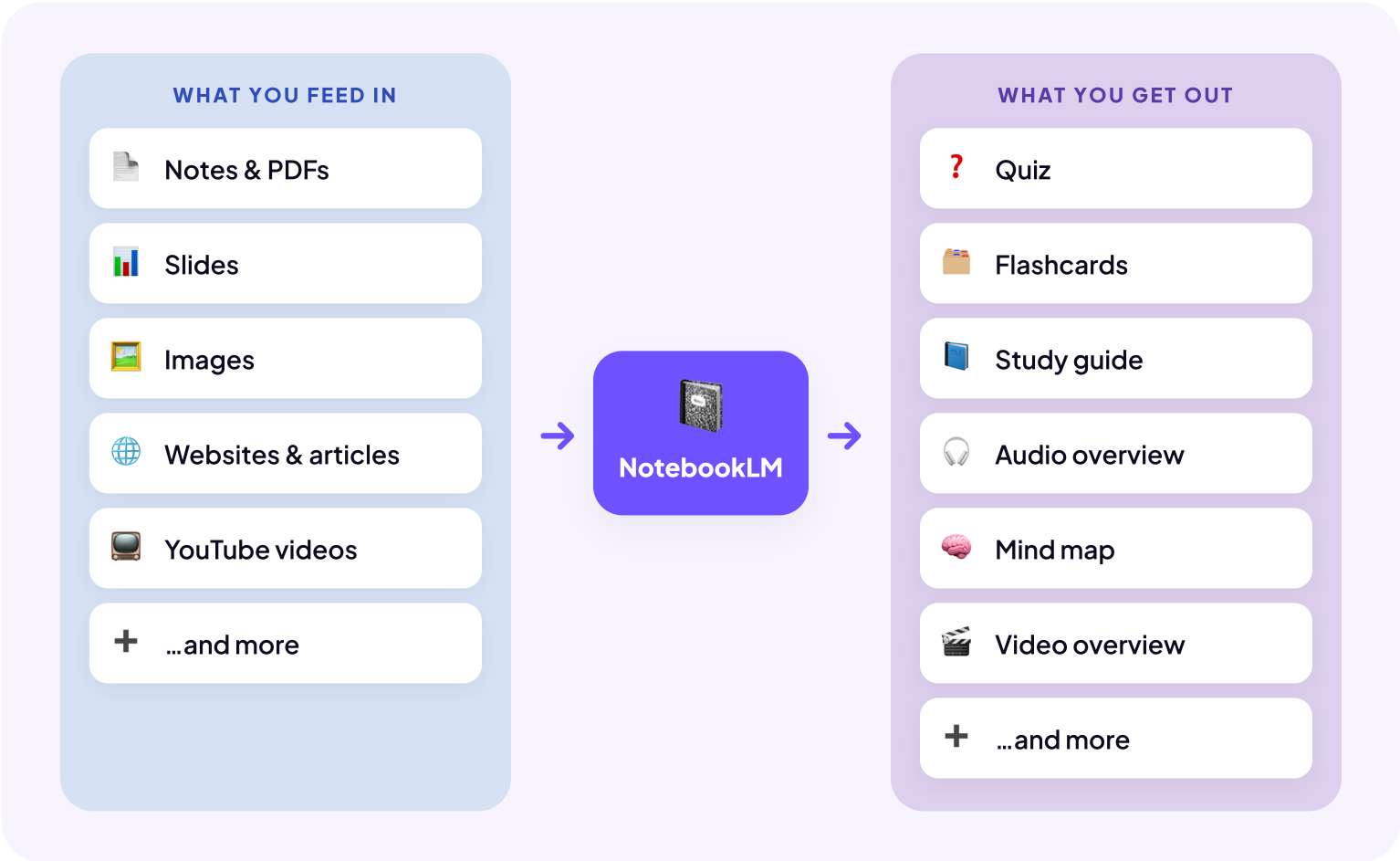
START HERE

Use NotebookLM as your main study tool. The clue is in the name: it was built for learning.

ChatGPT or Claude can do most of the same things, but it’s more difficult because they weren’t designed with the goal of learning.

HOW NOTEBOOKLM WORKS

Feed it your own study materials, and it turns them into the kind of study tool that fits you best: audio to listen to, quizzes to test yourself, and more. You choose.



BEST PRACTICES

Here’s how to use NotebookLM to its full potential.

1  **One notebook per subject**

Keep AP History and Chemistry in separate notebooks. Mixing sources confuses the model and gives you muddled study guides. Name each one clearly and treat it like its own binder.

2  **Feed it a few angles, not one**

For a big test, give it everything your teacher handed you: your class notes (so it keeps your teacher’s wording), the slides, and any video or link the teacher shared. NotebookLM reads a video’s transcript and blends it with your notes, so everything it gives back stays true to your class.

3  **Quiz yourself blind**

Re-reading notes feels productive, but that’s recognition, not recall. Generate a quiz, close everything, and take it cold.

“Generate a 10-question quiz from these sources only. Don’t show the answers yet. Wait for mine, then grade me.”

4  **Review on the go**

Have NotebookLM make an audio overview, then play it while you drive, walk, or work out. It turns dead time into another pass over the material.

5  **Trace it back to learn it**

When something doesn’t fully click, click its numbered citation to jump straight to the spot in your own notes it came from. Reading the original material is often what makes it land, and it’s faster than re-reading the whole chapter.